Epistola ad comitem Ballestrem Baronem Heermann et comitem de Preysing

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E P I S T O L A Sanctissimi D. N. Leonis X l i i ad comitem de B a l l e s t r e m , L i b e - rum B a r o n e m H e e r m a n n comitem de Preysing ; occasione obitus illustris L. W i n d s t h o r s t , cuius vestigia sequi exoratur in patriae et fidei studio.

Dilecti Filii salutem et Apostolicam benedictionem.

S u m m a a n i m o r u m c o n i u n c t i o q u a e v o b i s fuit c u m e g r e g i o Viro Ludovico Windthor st, etsi N o s m i n i m e latebat, e x p l o r a - d o r t a m e n N o b i s extitit e x iis q u a e t e l e g r a p h i c a s c r i p t i o n e per- ferri a d N o s c u r a v i s t i s , c o m m u n i v e s t r o e t c o l l e g a r u m catholi- c o r u m nomine, per dilectum lilium N o s t r u m Cardinalem a pu- blicis n e g o t i i s a d m i n i s t r u m . I u s t o e n i m v e r o e t a c e r b o d o l o r e affectos v o s e s s e i n t e l l i g i m u s e x i n s p e r a t o e i u s Viri obitu, c u i u s religio, i n t e g r i t a s , p r u d e n t i a , a l i a q u e a n i m i o r n a m e n t a p e r s p e c t a p r a e c e t e r i s v o b i s fuere, qui i p s u m d u c e m s e q u u t i i n officii g r a - vissimi p e r f u n c t i o n e , n o n m i n u s l a b o r u m e t c o n s i l i o r u m socii q u a m l a u d i s e i u s p a r t i c i p e s extitistis. Vestra, e n i m c o n s e n s i o n e e t suffragiis fretus, m a x i m i s rei c h r i s t i a n a e e t p u b l i c a e t e m p o - r i b u s , E c c l e s i a e r a t i o n e s e t i u r a s t r e n u e defendit, c a u s a m q u e iustitiae s e m e l s u s c e p t a m m a g n o a n i m o t u e r i p e r r e x i t , d o n e c e a se a s s e q u u t u m videret q u a e animo constanter intenderat. Merito a u t e m p a r t i u m v e s t r a r u m p r i n c i p e m e u m v o s h a b u i s s e gloriamini, qui n u n q u a m se a d v e r s a n t i u m viribus aut p o p u l a - r i b u s f l u c t i b u s g r a d u m o v e r i p a s s u s est, q u i i t a p a t r i a m d i l e x i t e t d e b i t a m P r i n c i p i o b s e r v a n t i a m ostendit, u t n u n q u a m h a e c of- ficia a religionis c u l t u s e i u n x e r i t , a t q u e i t a r a t i o n u m p o n d e r e solidaeque eloquentiae robore eos qui contra sentiebant oppu- g n a v i t , u t facile a g n i t u esset, e u m veritatis s t u d i o a d c e r t a n d u m , n o n u l l a c o m m o d i a u t h o n o r i s c u p i d i t a t e m o v e r i . — E q u i d e m h a e c e i u s m e r i t a , uti p a r e r a t , p r o b a t i s s i m a h a b u i m u s ; i d q u e c u m alias, o b l a t a o c c a s i o n e , testati s u m u s , t u m n u p e r h o c a n n o , q u u m , r e d e u n t e a n n i v e r s a r i a die c o r o n a t i o n i s N o s t r a e , n o v a h o - noris accessione i p s u m a u g e r e voluimus, adlectum n e m p e inter E q u i t e s p r i m i Ordinis Sancti G r e g o r i i M a g n i i n s i g n i b u s e i u s or- nare. Quod si morte p r a e r e p t u s hoc amoris et existimationis N o s t r a e t e s t i m o n i o frui n o n potuit, c e r t a s p e s N o s s o l a t u r e t r e - creat, q u a e i l l u m N o b i s o s t e n d i t a m p l i o r i b u s p r a e m i i s a Deo or- natum, e a m q u e a d e p t u m incommutabilem gloriam, q u a nulla illustrior a c b e a t i o r est h o m i n i b u s e x p e t e n d a . V o s interim, dilecti f i l i i , v i r t u t i s m e m o r e s e t e x e m p l o r u m tanti d u c i s , f i r m i t e r vestigia e i u s insistite, a r c t a m i n t e r v o s r e - tinete c o n c o r d i a m , q u a m i p s e i n e o c u i praefuit a g m i n e , n a v i t e r s t u d i o s e q u e s e r v a v i t , a c c e r t u m h a b e t e q u o d ille s e m p e r a n i m o d e f i x u m habuit, p r o s p e r i t a t i e t g l o r i a e c o m m u n i s p a t r i a e e o con- s u l t i u s a v o b i s p r o s p e c t u m iri, q u o i m p e n s i u s v o s p r a e b u e r i t i s fideles Deo et E c c l e s i a e m a t r i o b s e q u e n t e s . — Sic v o s s o c i o s q u e v e s t r o s p r o p i t i u s D e u s t u e a t u r a c sospitet, e i u s q u e favoris a u - s p e x sit Apostolica b e n e d i c t i o , q u a m voláis s i n g u l i s u n i v e r s i s peramanter impertimus. D a t u m R o m a e a p u d S . P e t r u m die x i x M a r t i a n o MDCCCXCI, Pontificatus N o s t r i d e c i m o q u a r t o .

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